

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD FORM

NEW STATE RECORD 1/1UNUSUAL RECORD 1/1

Please print or type. Attach photographs and additional pages if necessary.

Species: BLACK-BELLIED WHISTLING DUCK / DENDROCYGNA AUTUMNALIS
(Vernacular Name) (Scientific Name)Date(s): 11 JULY 91Number of birds seen: 1 Sex: UNK Plumage: ADULT

Latilong: _____ Distribution Code: _____ Habitat Code: _____

Locality: RESERVOIR ON RD 124 2.5 MILES EAST OF RD 67, NORTH OF RD 124
PANNEE NATL GRASSLANDS Elevation: _____Nearest town: FT COLLINS (CARA) COLORADO County: WeldTime(s) observed: 1230 - 1240Duration of observation (e.g. 1 sec., 5 min., etc.): 10 MIN

Other observers who saw the bird with you (give names, addresses, telephone numbers):

BECKY BROGAN, SAME ADDRESS

Other observers who saw the bird independently (give names, addresses, telephone numbers):

UNK

Light conditions (position of bird to light and shade, direction and strength of light):

OVERHEAD NOON SUNOptical equipment used (e.g. power, types): 7X AND 9X BINOCULARSDistance and how measured: EST. 200' (FROM MEMORY - COULD BE OFF)If photographed, type of equipment and film: NIKON ECOS/TAMRON 90-300 ZOOM
KODACHROME 200Who else photographed the bird: UNK

Describe the bird's behavior (e.g. flying, feeding, or habits used in identifying):

STANDING UPRIGHT AT WATERS EDGE, 'NERVOUSLY' LOOKING AROUND

Describe in detail the bird's relative size, overall shape, plumage and color pattern. Include details of bill, wing and tail shape. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird. Reference to its resemblance to field guide descriptions and illustrations is not enough. Describe only what you actually observed in the field:

NOT MUCH CONFUSION HERE: UPRIGHT LARGE DUCK, ORANGE BILLPALE TAN FACE, BROWN CHEST, BLACK BELLY, PINK LEGS. NO BANDS
ON LEGS NOTED

Description (continued): THERE WERE SEVERAL OTHER DUCKS IN
THE AREA (RUDOLPH, N. PINTAIL, BW TEAL, ETC) WHICH WERE
HEADING FOR THE RUSHES WHEN WE LEFT. CAME BACK
45 MINS LATER AND NO DUCKS (INC B/W DUCK) WERE VISIBLE

Describe the bird's song and call, if given, including method of delivery,
(i.e. from perch, in flight, duration):

NONE

Describe the general and specific habitat in which you observed the bird:

NORTH END OF RESERVOIR NORTH OF RD 124. RESERVOIR WITH FLOATING
VEGETATION SURROUNDED BY REEDS, RUSHES ETC

How did you eliminate similarly appearing species?

NONE

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species?

WILD BIRDS IN TEXAS (HILL COUNTRY/LUNDALE) AND RG VALLEY AND SE
ARIZONA, ESCAPEE IN C. SINCLAIR, GA. HAVE ALSO SEEN FULVUS IN FL

List books, illustration, recordings, other birders, etc. consulted and how
this influenced your identification:

a) At time of observation: NOT NECESSARY

b) After observation: _____

This report was written from reports made during _____, after
observation _____, from memory ✓

Date and time report was written: 1000 - 27 JUL 91

Reporting observer: GIFF BEATON Signature: Giff Beaton

Address: 1833 BLACKWATER DR, MARIETTA GA 30066 (404) 516-752

All reports will be maintained permanently at the address below:

Return to: CURATOR, DEPARTMENT OF ZOOLOGICAL COLLECTIONS
DENVER MUSEUM OF NATURAL HISTORY
CITY PARK
DENVER, CO 80205

* ENCLOSED PHOTO IS FROM A SLIDE, WHICH IS BETTER. IF
PHOTO IS NOT SUFFICIENT YOU MAY BORROW THE SLIDE. I
WOULD LIKE TO KNOW IF ANYONE ELSE SAW THIS BIRD, IF POSS.

8-91-14

Black-bellied Whistling-Duck, 11 July 1991, Pawnee National Grassland, Weld Co. Photograph by Giff Beaton



8-91-14

A

N/O

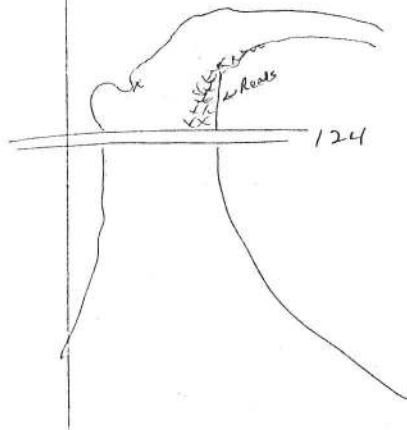
21 JUL 91

Dear Hugh-

Enclosed is a picture from a recent birding trip to Colorado by Becky Brogan and myself. Our last day (11 July) we went to the Pawnee National Grasslands and found this adult Black-bellied Whistling Duck. The bird was found at about 1230 in the afternoon at the reservoir (in Lane guide) 2 1/2 miles east of Rd 67 on Rd 124. Road 124 splits the reservoir (see drawing) and the duck was north of the road at the "x". We took this picture and looked around for anything else (Ruddy, N. Pintail, Am. Coot, Pied Billed Grebe, many Blue-winged Teal) before looking at the south end of the reservoir for 45 minutes or so. When we came back, all of the ducks save the Coots and one Teal were gone or at least not visible. Some were heading for the reeds when we first showed up and presumably that's where they went as none were seen flying off. We hung around there for another 30 minutes but the ducks stayed out of sight. The Whistling Duck had seemed like a normal skittish wild duck, acting like these ducks do in Texas and Arizona (looking around nervously, etc). We saw no bands.

Hope this is of interest to you - if you need any more info I'd be happy to help. The original slide is better than your photo if you need it.

Giff Beaton
1833 Blackwater Dr
Marietta GA 30066
(404) 516-7521



This site was confirmed to look like the photograph by Joe Himmel in July 92.